

LIWELILE IMPUMELELO COMMUNITY CENTRE

Programme 1: Elderly Feeding & Wellness –

Nutritional Guidelines

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22 Fox Glove Avenue, Primrose, Germiston



Core Nutritional Principles

Principle	Application
Balanced meals	Each meal includes protein, carbohydrate, vegetables, healthy fats
Soft texture	Foods are cooked soft, mashed, or finely chopped to accommodate chewing difficulties
Low sodium	Minimal added salt; use herbs and spices for flavour
Low sugar	No added sugar; natural sweetness from fruits and vegetables
High fibre	Include legumes, whole grains, vegetables for digestive health
Hydration	Water, tea, milk, and soups offered throughout the day

Daily Nutrient Targets (per meal)

Nutrient	Target	Sources
Protein	15–20 g	Chicken, fish, eggs, beans, lentils, milk
Carbohydrates	40–50 g	Pap, rice, samp, potatoes, pumpkin
Vegetables	2 portions	Cabbage, spinach, carrots, beetroot, green beans
Fibre	8–10 g	Legumes, whole grains, vegetables
Fats	10–15 g	Vegetable oil, margarine, small amounts of butter

Special Diet Guidelines

Diabetic-Friendly

Limit: White pap, rice, sugar, fruit juice, sweetened drinks

Encourage: Brown rice, samp, beans, lentils, vegetables, whole fruits

Snacks: Fresh fruit, unsweetened yoghurt, maas

Hypertension (Low Salt)

Limit: Added salt, processed foods, stock cubes

Encourage: Herbs (parsley, rosemary, garlic), lemon juice, natural spices

Snacks: Unsalted crackers, fresh fruit, unsalted nuts

Soft Food (Chewing Difficulty)

Texture: Mashed, blended, finely chopped, or pureed

Examples: Soft pap, mashed potato, minced meat, well-cooked vegetables, smooth soups

Avoid: Hard crusts, tough meats, raw vegetables, nuts

Sample Weekly Menu – Nutritional Breakdown

Day	Meal	Protein (g)	Carbs (g)	Veg	Fibre (g)	Notes
Mon	Soft pap, veg stew, egg	12	45	2	6	Balanced
Tue	Brown rice, lentil curry, spinach	14	50	2	10	High fibre
Wed	Bean & potato mash, gravy, pumpkin	10	55	1	8	Soft
Thu	Mealie rice, chicken stew, butternut	18	45	1	5	Protein rich
Fri	Hake stew, soft porridge, veg medley	16	40	2	6	Low fat

Kitchen Practices

Practice	Why
Cook from fresh	Maximises nutrients, minimises preservatives
Portion control	Ensures consistent nutrition and minimises waste
Taste test before serving	Adjust seasoning for special diets
Record special diets	Maintain register; label meals clearly
Hydration station	Water, tea, juice available throughout the day

Monitoring & Compliance

Daily: Check meal temperatures, portion sizes, special diet adherence

Weekly: Review menu against nutritional targets

Monthly: Weigh beneficiaries (optional) to monitor health trends